
THE COMPOUND EFFECT

BRAND & DESIGN SYSTEM

One system for the franchise. **The Compound Effect** (2010) and **The Compound Effect in Business** (April 2027) are not two brands. They are one brand printed on opposite grounds, and almost everything in this document follows from that.

V1.1 · OCTOBER 2026 · GOVERNS THECOMPOUNDEFFECT.COM AND EVERY COMPOUND EFFECT
WEB PROPERTY

01 · PACKAGE CONTENTS

WHAT SHIPS, AND WHAT IT IS FOR.

This document exists in two forms and they are kept in sync. The live page is the working reference. The package is the portable copy: self-contained HTML that opens anywhere with no network, a PDF for print and email, and the real source files a vendor or contractor will ask for.

brand-guide.html

This document, self-contained. CSS and fonts inlined, opens with no network.

brand-guide.pdf

Print and share version.

fonts/

The two licensed faces, self-hosted woff2. See section 08 for the licence position.

logos/dh/

Darren Hardy parent marks. Author identity, used in the byline position and the footer.

logos/tce/

The Compound Effect franchise lockup, light and dark.

logos/tceb/

The in-Business lockup, light and dark.

covers/

Both jackets at full resolution. These are the only product imagery the brand owns.

tceb.css

The live stylesheet the token block in section 16 is drawn from.

Keep them in sync. The live page links the real `tceb.css`, so it cannot drift from production. The package inlines a snapshot. When the stylesheet changes in a way that matters, the package is rebuilt, not hand-edited.

The 2010 jacket is red and black on white. The 2027 jacket is white and red on black. Measured side by side, the two reds sit within a few points of each other. The books were never two identities. They are an inversion of one.

THE COMPOUND EFFECT

THE COMPOUND EFFECT

ground #FFFFFF

red #E02726

ink #241F21 warm near-black

2010. Red on white, with a black band carrying the author. Light is the ground and the ink is the object.

THE COMPOUND EFFECT IN BUSINESS

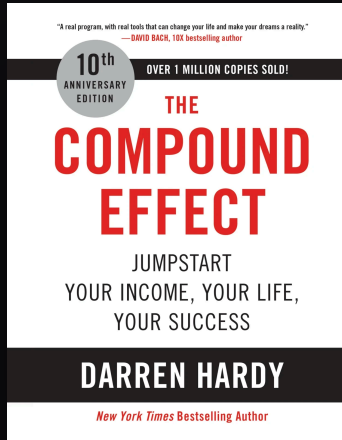
IN BUSINESS

ground #000000

red #E1132E / #FF0047

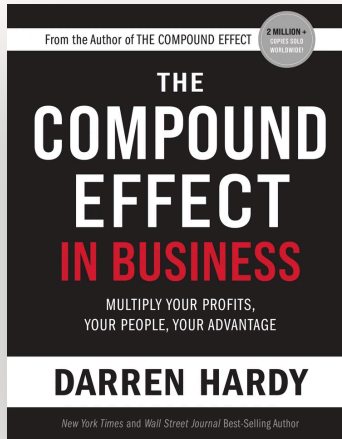
ink #FFFFFF

2027. White on black, with white bands carrying the author. Dark is the ground and the light is the object.



A WHITE BOOK
GOES ON DARK

THE JACKET IS THE LIGHTEST THING IN THE FRAME.
IT SEPARATES BY VALUE ON ITS OWN.



A BLACK BOOK
GOES ON LIGHT

THE JACKET IS THE DARKEST THING IN THE FRAME.
PUT IT ON BLACK AND IT DISAPPEARS.

The rule that falls out of it. A white book needs a dark ground to exist against. A black book needs a light one. So **TCE artwork goes on**

dark, TCEB artwork goes on light, and any page showing both has to give each its own field rather than splitting the difference.

Inversion is not a palette swap. When a treatment moves between the two grounds, invert the physics, not the colours. A glow becomes a shadow. A vignette that lightens becomes one that darkens. An object that separates by emitting becomes one that separates by casting. Swapping hex values alone produces the effect that looks correct in a spec and wrong on a screen.

03 · IDENTITY

THREE LAYERS, IN THIS ORDER.

The author, the franchise, the book. Every page carries at least the first two, and they are never given equal weight in the same view.

1 · DARREN HARDY

The author mark. This is his brand before it is a book brand, and the franchise sits under it. Used in the byline position on a jacket, and in the footer on the web. It is never the primary mark on a book page and never competes with the title lockup.

Set in Franklin Gothic. His name is the one place that face appears. Using it anywhere else spends the only thing that makes the byline distinct.

2 · THE COMPOUND EFFECT

The franchise lockup: **THE / COMPOUND / EFFECT** stacked in the display face. This is the parent form and it is identical on both books.

It carries the equity of two million copies. It is the constant, and the reason the second book is recognised at all.

MONOGRAM · WHITE ON DARK · PRIMARY



MONOGRAM · REVERSE · DARK ON LIGHT



LOCKUP · WHITE ON DARK · AS USED IN THE FOOTER



DARREN HARDY

LOCKUP · REVERSE · DARK ON LIGHT



DARREN HARDY

A drawn mark, so it holds at any size, in one colour, and on anything printed. The monogram alone is for tight spaces and favicons. The lockup is the footer form and is exactly what darrenhardy.com uses:

mark at 48px, name in the body face at 17px with 0.28em tracking, 14px between them. **The reverse is the same artwork with the ink flipped**, not a second drawing, so the two can never drift apart.

3 · THE TAIL

Each book extends the parent lockup rather than replacing it. The 2010 book adds nothing. The 2027 book adds **IN BUSINESS**, set smaller than EFFECT, in red, on its own line. A future title would take the same position at the same relative size.

No The tail set at the same size as EFFECT. It is a qualifier, not a third word of the title.

No The franchise lockup and the DH mark at matching weight in one view. One leads.

No Franklin Gothic anywhere except his name.

Yes Lockup centred, its own clear space of at least the cap-height of COMPOUND on all four sides.

OPEN · NEEDS DH

The **DH monogram is already a drawn mark** and needs nothing. It is the **franchise lockup** that is still type set in the display face. For a four-site property that is worth revisiting: a drawn wordmark survives at small sizes, in one colour, and on merchandise in a way that set type does not. Flagged rather than assumed.

TWO GROUNDS. NOTHING BETWEEN THEM.

The jacket does not use a tinted paper, a cream, or a warm grey. It is pure white against pure black, and the hardness of that edge is the identity.

WHITE

#FFFFFF

Flaps, back panel, the bands that frame the cover. Where the argument is made and the reading happens.

BLACK

#000000

The cover itself. Where the title lives, and the only ground gold is permitted on.

This corrects the earlier proposal. A warm paper at #fbfaf8 and a mist grey at #dcd9d5 were drafted before the jacket was available. They soften a system that is meant to be hard, and they cost contrast: the red measures **4.64:1** on warm paper, which fails body text, and **4.85:1** on pure white, which passes. The jacket is both more elegant and more accessible.

ONE RED. ONCE.

On the jacket the red appears on a single phrase per surface. **IN BUSINESS** on the cover. One sentence on the flap. One word in the URL. That discipline is the reason it lands.

Red

#E1132E

The accent on white. Headlines, one emphasis, and button fills with white type.

4.85:1 on white · passes

Red bright

#FF0047

The same role on black. Type only. Never a button fill: white on it is 3.93.

5.34:1 on black · passes

Gold

#D4A017

Founding tiers only, and only on dark. Gold fills carry black type, never white.

8.84:1 on black · 2.38 on white

Gold lux

#CAA76A

The softer register, for when the tier should read premium rather than loud.

9.25:1 on black · 2.27 on white

Each red passes on exactly one ground. #E1132E is 4.85:1 on white and 4.33:1 on black. #FF0047 is 5.34:1 on black and 3.93:1 on white. So they are not interchangeable and neither is a "lighter version" of the other: white surfaces take #E1132E, black surfaces take #FF0047, and swapping them fails contrast in both directions.

No Red on red. Red headline above a red button is two shouts, not one.

No Gold anywhere a light ground is in play. #D4A017 is 2.38:1 on white.

No Gold type set beside red type at the same size. They are only 1.65:1 apart in luminance, so they vibrate. Separate them by size, weight or space.

No A second accent hue. There is not one, and adding one breaks the jacket.

Yes Long stretches with no colour at all. That is what makes the red work.

GREYS ARE **TYPE TIERS**, NOT GROUNDS.

White, light grey and silver belong in this system. They earn their place as levels of type and as rules, which is how the jacket uses them. They are not additional backgrounds.

#000000 Display, on white	#262626 Body, on white	#4D4D4D 8.45 · secondary
#6E6E6E 5.10 · fine print	#B3B3B3 10.02 on black	#E0E0E0 Rules and borders
#F0F0F0 Callout fields		

Where silver is allowed to be a surface. One case only: a flat field behind a callout or a spec table, at #F0F0F0 or lighter. Anything darker becomes a third ground, and a third ground is what made the previous draft read as a hodge-podge.

CONFIRMED FROM THE JACKET.

All three are settled, licensed and self-hosted. The title is **Bebas Neue**. His name is **Franklin Gothic Condensed**. The display and name faces are the licensed originals. What is still open is whether the jacket's title was set in Bebas at all: see the note below.

DISPLAY · THE TITLE

BEBAS NEUE

Headlines, eyebrows, moneylines, tier names, any standalone number. Always uppercase, which is free because the face has no lowercase.

Licensed and self-hosted in five weights: Thin, Light, Book, Regular and Bold. Oswald stays in the stack as a fallback only.

THE NAME · CONDENSED

DARREN HARDY

His name only, wherever it is set large: the cover band, a page footer, a signature. It is deliberately not the display face, which is what makes the byline read as a separate voice.

Licensed and self-hosted. **Archivo Narrow** stays in the stack as a fallback only.

Inter

Every paragraph, lede, caption, form field, button and piece of fine print.

If a person reads more than one line of it, it is Inter.

No **Never let the browser synthesise a weight.** The family ships five real cuts, so ask for one that **exists** : 100, 300, 400, 500 or 700. Anything else is faked and smears the letterforms, which is how the jacket builds its hierarchy anyway.

No Never set a paragraph in Bebas. It is a display face with no lowercase.

No Never set a headline in Inter or Franklin. Those read as a web app and a byline respectively.

No Never italicise. The system has no italic: emphasis is the `em` is redefined as red rather than slanted.

Yes Franklin is reserved for his name. Using it elsewhere spends the one thing that makes the byline distinct.

No **Bebas below about 28px.** At button, label and tag sizes, and worst with wide tracking, it turns thin and spindly on screen. Confirmed in review on a live page, October 2026: "This font really isn't working on web." Buttons, labels, tags, captions and notes are set in the body face at 600–800 weight with modest tracking (.06–.08em).

Both licences are bought and wired in. Five real Bebas weights and Franklin Gothic Condensed, self-hosted as woff2, downloadable in section 08. What is **not** settled is whether the jacket was set in Bebas at all. At the jacket's own cap height Bebas gives COMPOUND 640 and EFFECT 469 only with roughly +0.09em and +0.14em of tracking, and at those values the letters visibly spray apart because the letterforms are the wrong shape. Franklin Gothic Condensed matches EFFECT

within 3% but runs 21% wide on COMPOUND, so it is not that either. The lockup keeps true proportions and honest spacing rather than forcing the measurement, and identifying the real face is a question for whoever set the jacket.

Still open: the body face on the jacket. DH confirmed the title and the name. The flap and back-panel copy is set in a condensed gothic that is plausibly Franklin, not Inter. If it is, there is a case for moving web body copy to Franklin too and running the whole property on two faces instead of three. Worth confirming before the type system is locked.

08 · LICENCE & THE FILES

PURCHASED. SELF-HOST THEM.

DH confirmed the faces and the licences are bought. Both families are below, as web woff2 and as the original desktop files. Nothing here is a substitute any more.

WEIGHT

DOWNLOAD

WOFF2

DISPLAY · BEBAS NEUE

Regular
bebas-neue-regular.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

26 KB

Book
bebas-neue-book.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

29 KB

Bold
bebas-neue-bold.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

27 KB

Light
bebas-neue-light.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

27 KB

Thin
bebas-neue-thin.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

23 KB

THE NAME · FRANKLIN GOTHIC CONDENSED

Condensed
franklin-gothic-condensed.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

14 KB

Std Condensed
franklin-gothic-std-condensed.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

15 KB

Std Extra Condensed
franklin-gothic-std-extracond.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

14 KB

TEXT · FRANKLIN GOTHIC

Book
franklin-gothic-book.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

66 KB

Book Italic
franklin-gothic-book-italic.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

71 KB

Medium
franklin-gothic-medium.woff2

[woff2](#)
[original](#)

Medium Italic

franklin-gothic-medium-italic.woff2

woff2original

69 KB

Std Roman

franklin-gothic-std-roman.woff2

woff2original

15 KB

Self-host, never a CDN. Serve the woff2 from the property itself via @font-face. No Google Fonts, no third-party host. That keeps the licence auditable, removes a render-blocking third party, and stops the type changing under the brand if a CDN changes what it serves. The originals are for desktop and print, not the web.

What the purchase settles. Franklin Gothic was bought in **Book** and **Medium** with italics, which are text weights rather than display ones. That is the answer to the open question about the body face: this is a **two-face system**, Bebas for display and Franklin for everything else, not a three-face one.

09 · THE SCALE

NINE STEPS. USE THESE, NOT NEW ONES.

Every size below is already built into tceb.css. Display sizes are fluid and clamp between a phone minimum and a desktop maximum.

.d1 Bebas Neue 700 caps
42 → 96 0.94
The page headline. One only.

.d2 Bebas Neue 700 caps
32 → 60 0.98
Section headline.

.d3 Bebas Neue 700 caps
23 → 36 1.04
Sub-section, moneyline, pull quote.

.d4 Bebas Neue 700 caps
28 → 34 1.0
Card titles and tier names. **This is the floor for Bebas.** Anything smaller (labels, tags, buttons) is the body face, 700, caps.

.eyebrow ~~Bebas Neue caps~~
— —
Retired, October 2026. No short-rule-plus-letterspaced-label above headlines. Lead with the headline. If a section genuinely needs a marker, it is a solid plate or a number, not a line and a word.

.lede Inter 400
17 → 20 1.62
The paragraph directly under a headline.

.body Inter 400
17 1.72
Running copy. Max 66 characters per line.

.small Inter 400
13.5 1.60
Captions, notes, table cells.

.fine Inter 400

Legal, disclaimers, unsubscribe. Grey, underline links only.

AT SIZE

.d1

MONTH THIRTY-ONE

.d2

THE OPERATING SYSTEM

.d3

THE PENNY DOUBLES. AN ORG CHART MULTIPLIES.

.d4

THE COMPOUNDING AUDIT

.lede

You just did not write it. It is running right now, made of defaults: what happens when nobody decides.

.body

Every strategy, tool, campaign, hire and technology you install sits on top of that system and performs, or fails, according to it.

.small

A dozen leaks of the same size runs \$450,000 a year.

.fine

Year two renews at \$9,995. Cancel any time.

The caps ceiling. Display is always uppercase, and uppercase is capped by word count, not by line count: **eight words maximum, six preferred.** A longer idea splits into a short caps punch plus a sentence-case line beneath it. This is the rule most often broken, because a headline that fits the box can still be four words too long.

10 · COMPOSITION

THE BAND.

The cover's structure is a black field framed by two white bands. That device is the layout system, not just cover art. It gives a page its rhythm without a single extra colour.

FROM THE AUTHOR OF THE COMPOUND EFFECT

2 MILLION + COPIES SOLD

THE COMPOUND EFFECT IN BUSINESS

MULTIPLY YOUR PROFITS, YOUR PEOPLE, YOUR ADVANTAGE

DARREN HARDY

THECOMPOUNDEFFECT.COM/**BUSINESS**

How it carries to a page. Black section, white band above and below, the band holding one small line of type. On a web page the bands become the nav and the footer, and the black field becomes the statement between them. Same device, same proportions.

11 · BUTTONS & THE CTA SYSTEM

ONE PRIMARY PER VIEW.

Two tiers, and they never appear at the same weight in the same screen. The ghost invites. The solid converts.

ON LIGHT

SOLID · RESTING

GET ON THE LIST →

SOLID · HOVER

GET ON THE LIST →

GHOST · RESTING

SEE THE BOOK

GHOST · HOVER

SEE THE BOOK

ON DARK

SOLID · RESTING

GET ON THE LIST →

SOLID · HOVER

GET ON THE LIST →

GHOST · RESTING

SEE THE BOOK

GHOST · HOVER

SEE THE BOOK

The right-hand button in each pair has the hover state forced on so it survives a screenshot and a print. The left-hand ones hover for real.

No **Nothing darkens on hover. Ever.** A solid holds its fill and responds by GROWING: it scales up about 5%, lifts, and the arrow travels. The change has to be obvious at a glance, or the button reads as inert.

No **That includes a transparent button on a dark ground.** A ghost on dark fills with LIGHT on hover and flips its type dark. Filling it with anything darker than the ground reads as switched off, which is the same failure as a darkening solid and is easier to miss because the resting state has no fill to compare against.

No Pill shapes. 3px radius everywhere. The jacket has no round corners and neither does this.

No Two solids in one view. If a second action is needed it is a ghost or a link.

Yes Ghost fills on hover, always toward the lighter side of its ground, type flipping to the ground colour.

No **No coloured glow.** A blurred red shadow reads as pink, which puts a colour in the palette that is not in it. Lift with a neutral shadow and leave the red in the fill.

Yes Placement: ghost in the nav, content between, solid at the close.

Yes **Tactile, not flat.** A solid carries a physical bottom edge: a 6px offset shadow in a deeper shade of its own fill, with a 1px inset highlight on top. Hover lifts it about 3px and grows it; press sinks it about 5px in 60ms. The fill itself never changes, so the "never darken" rule holds.

Yes A single light sheen that sweeps across the face on hover, once, in about .7s. It reads as polish, not decoration.

Yes Button labels in the body face, 700, caps, ~.08em tracking. Never Bebas at button size (section 07).

Why the hover rule exists. Darkening on hover reads as the button being spent or disabled. Growing and moving the arrow reads as the

button responding. The colour is a brand constant and hover is not the place to modulate it.

12 · FORMS & THE GLASS CARD

A LENS, NOT A PANE.

Frosted glass is one layer: blur plus a milky veil. It hides what is behind it and reads flat. The brand's form card is a lens. The body is barely blurred and all the character lives at the rim, where the light bends.

frost

The legibility blur. Always on, and deliberately separate from the refraction so a browser that cannot render the bend still produces a readable form.

refract

The bend itself: a displacement filter masked to the rim only. Refraction belongs in the bevel; the centre of a slab passes light straight through.

lens

A second, harder filter faded inward over the rim. A hard-edged mask here reads as a picture frame.

fringe

Chromatic dispersion, kept under 10% or it stops reading as glass and starts reading as a mistake.

edge

Every bevel and inset highlight. Above the glass, or its own blur softens the 1px lit edge.

spec

A highlight travelling around the rim, driven by an animated conic angle.

The trap that silently kills it. An element with `backdrop-filter`, `isolation:isolate`, or `will-change:transform` becomes a **backdrop root**. A descendant's `backdrop-filter` can then only see what is painted inside that root, which is nothing. The card paints, the glass does not, and there is no error. If the glass is missing, look for a backdrop root above it before looking at the filter.

On a light ground, commit to black. A dark card at 20–30% over a photograph is not glass, it is dirt: the plate shows through as grey and the eyebrow drops to around 3:1. The light version is a solid near-black slab that keeps the rim, the bevel and the specular, and gives up the transparency that was buying nothing.

Floating "thought" panels. Approved October 2026 and wanted "a lot": a real person in the hero (Darren, or a member) surrounded by small glass panels showing their world. A text to a friend, a notification, an email ready to send, a card from the product. Rules: never over the face or the headline; each panel at its own depth and drifting on its own slow timing; two at most on a phone; real product language in every panel, never lorem.

13 · NAV & FOOTERS

TWO FOOTERS. PICK DELIBERATELY.

The jacket's device carries straight to the page: a band above, a band below, and the statement between them. The nav is the top band. The footer is the bottom one.

The live .s_lim modifier: same footer, grid removed, top rule and top padding dropped. Sign-up, sale lead-in and confirmation pages all take this. A page whose job is one decision does not offer twelve other ways to leave.



Darren Hardy is the unfair advantage for unusually driven business leaders building something that matters.



SUPPORT

HELP CENTER

CAREERS

EXPLORE

ABOUT

RESOURCES

DAILY MENTORING

PODCAST

BOOKS

FEATURED SLOT

Whatever is being promoted right now.
Everything else in this footer is identical to
darrenhardy.com and does not change.

Lifted from the live site. The brand column, both link columns, the socials and the legal row are unchanged. **Only the BMC|COLLECTIVE feature is replaced**, because that block is the one that changes per property and per campaign.

No Full footer on a confirmation page.

No A solid CTA in the nav. The nav invites; it does not convert.

No Anything outside the featured slot written as if it knows what is in the slot.

Yes Nav carries the franchise lockup at small size and one ghost action, right-aligned.

Yes The DH mark lives in the footer, in both variants.

Why the slot is a placeholder here. A brand guide that pins the promo to one campaign is out of date the day the campaign changes. What is specified is the slot: where it sits, how much room it gets, and that it is dark ground with white type. What goes in it is not this document's job.

14 • TESTIMONIALS & IMAGERY

THE JACKET IS THE ONLY ASSET.

This property owns two pieces of real imagery: the two jackets. Everything else is borrowed, commissioned, or invented, and the rules differ sharply between those.

No **A testimonial is a banked result.** Already happened, with a magnitude. A projection, a compliment or an event story is not a testimonial, and a bigger number does not rescue a projection.

No Circular avatars. A rectangular portrait beside the quote, in a split layout.

No Cut-outs on a brand-colour field. Real photo on its real background. Colour lives in the card, never behind the head.

No A subject whose body is turned away from the copy. Fix by side or by mirror, and never mirror branded kit.

No Generated imagery of people or places. Retouching a real photograph is fine; generating one is not.

Yes **Every testimonial carries the person's real photo** unless told otherwise. If the best quote has no photo, use a different quote. Never ship a face-less quote and never generate one, test pages included.

Yes A straight crop is fine. A photo that arrives as a circle or a quote card is cropped to a rectangle from inside the real image, never extended.

Yes When the source is a fragment rather than a sentence, lead with the result as a number (2X) and set the fragment beneath it, so nothing is put in the person's mouth.

Separating a black book from a dark page. The jacket is the darkest thing in the frame, so it cannot be separated by value. It is separated by **light**: an ambient pool behind it, a rim along the lit edge, and a real contact shadow beneath. That is how black product is photographed and it is the answer to "the jacket is black so the page cannot be".

Give it thickness. A flat image of a cover reads as a picture of a book. A spine, a page edge and a floor read as a book. Where the object is the subject, build it.

MEASURED, NOT ASSUMED.

Every accent against every ground it is allowed on. 4.5:1 carries body text, 3:1 carries large text and UI. Anything below 3 does not carry type at all, whatever it looks like in a swatch.

TCE red on white #E02726 on #FFFFFF	4.68 BODY
TCE ink on white #241F21 on #FFFFFF	16.24 BODY
White on TCE band #FFFFFF on #241F21	16.24 BODY
TCEB red-ink on white #E1132E on #FFFFFF	4.85 BODY
TCEB bright red on black #FF0047 on #000000	5.34 BODY
TCEB red-ink on black #E1132E on #000000	4.33 LARGE ONLY
Gold on black #D4A017 on #000000	8.84 BODY
Gold on white #D4A017 on #FFFFFF	2.38 FAILS

Gold lux on black
#CAA76A on #000000

9.25 BODY

Grey 55 on white
#6E6E6E on #FFFFFF

5.10 BODY

Grey 30 on black
#B3B3B3 on #000000

10.02 BODY

The one that catches people. Gold is a dark-ground colour. On white it is 2.38:1 and illegible at any size. If a light ground is in play, the accent is red.

16 · WEB IMPLEMENTATION

THE TOKENS. USE THESE, NOT NEW ONES.

Paste block. Anything that has to sit on the ground must read a token that moves with the ground, never a hardcoded value.

```
:root{
  /* grounds */
  --c-white:#ffffff;    --c-black:#000000;    --c-near:#0e0d10;
  --c-paper:#fbfaf8;    --c-bone:#f0f0f0;    --c-ink:#241f21;

  /* accent. red once per view. gold on dark grounds only. */
  --c-red:#e1132e;      --c-red-bright:#ff0047;
  --c-gold:#d4a017;      --c-gold-lux:#caa76a;

  /* neutrals are type tiers, not grounds */
  --fg:#000;    --fg-soft:#4d4d4d;    --fg-mute:#6e6e6e;    --fg-fine:#b3b3b3;
```

```
/* type */
--font-display:'Bebas Neue','Oswald',sans-serif;
--font-name:'Franklin Gothic Condensed',sans-serif;
--font-body:system-ui,sans-serif;

/* geometry. 3px everywhere. no pills. */
--radius:3px; --container:1200px; --gutter:clamp(20px,4vw,56px);
}
```

The token trap. A value written as a literal inside a rule that also serves the other theme will be correct on one ground and wrong on the other, and it will not error. Vignettes, scrims, footers and anything inverted are where this happens. If it sits on the ground, it reads a token.

17 · MOTION

ALIVE BEFORE ANYONE TOUCHES IT.

A page that sits still reads flat, which is the word Darren uses for "like everything else". Motion here is depth and light, never decoration: objects that have weight, light that moves slowly, and type that arrives the way a room is lit.

ease

One curve for arrivals: **cubic-bezier(.2,.7,.2,1)**. Objects that lift use **cubic-bezier(.2,.8,.2,1)**.

reveal

Content rises 38px and fades in over .9s as it enters. Built so everything stays visible if the observer never fires (no blank page in previews, email clients or slow devices).

ambient

A soft light behind the headline drifts over 14s. Metallic type (gold on dark, red on light) runs a slow sheen over 7s. The page is moving before anyone scrolls.

depth

Objects (the jacket, a sheet, a card stack, an app panel) are built in layers at different depths and tilt with the pointer, about 16° across and 12° down. Nearer layers move more.

parallax

Rated by depth, never flat: the hero photo moves at about .18 of scroll and scales a fraction. Nothing else in the same view parallaxes.

stack

Long pages can pin each section while the next slides over it with a deep shadow. Sections stay square (see section 19).

marquee

One infinite band per page at most: outline and solid words alternating, 40s per loop, seamless (two identical sets, one wider than the viewport).

count

Stat numbers count up once on entry over 1.6s, ease-out.

press

Buttons lift 3px and grow 3% on hover, sink 5px on press in 60ms (section 11). Cards lift 4px.

reduced

prefers-reduced-motion turns off every ambient loop, tilt and reveal. The page must read completely without them.

Test motion in a real browser. The Claude preview pane does not fire scroll observers, so reveals, count-ups and lazy images look broken there and fine everywhere else.

HOW IT IS WRITTEN.

The type rules and the copy rules are one system. A headline that breaks these will look wrong no matter how it is set.

No **Em dashes.** Ever. Restructure the sentence.

No **"Buy."** They invest. They never purchase.

No Opening on the problem. Lead with the outcome and its emotion. Format, duration and mechanics never lead.

No An all-caps headline over eight words. Six is better. Split a longer idea into a caps punch plus sentence-case detail.

No Naming the paid product on a free or pre-sale page, testimonials included. Trim the quote instead.

No Funnel language anywhere a reader can see it, page names included.

Yes "Leader", not "owner".

Yes After a purchase, affirm the decision first and offer the multiplier second. No loss framing.

SETTING THE TITLE

The title has **two forms and they are not interchangeable**. Most mistakes with it come from setting one as though it were the other.

The stacked identity. Its breaks are **fixed**: THE / COMPOUND / EFFECT / tail. It is never re-flowed to fit a box, never set on one line, and never re-broken. Sizes and gaps are in section 03.

This is the only place THE stands alone. Seeing it on its own line is correct here and nowhere else.

2 · RUNNING FORM

The title inside a sentence or a headline. It is set inline and **it never breaks at any point**. If it will not fit, the line around it breaks, or the type gets smaller. The title does not give way.

Wrap it so the decision is not left to the browser:

```
<em class="tce">The Compound Effect</em>
.tce{ white-space: nowrap }
```

No **COMPOUND and EFFECT on separate lines in running text.** They are one word for breaking purposes. This is the most common failure and it happens silently at narrow widths.

No **THE separated from COMPOUND in running text.** Correct in the lockup, wrong everywhere else.

No IN BUSINESS split from the title it qualifies.

No Relying on the measure being wide enough today. It will not be on a phone.

Yes The whole title in one nowrap span, every time it appears in text.

Yes If that forces an ugly line, change the type size or the copy around it. Never the title.

Orphans are a type failure, not a copy failure. The display face is set in authored line breaks, not wrapped. A single word alone on a line is

the most common way to make this face look cheap. Size the type to the break, do not narrow the measure until the break appears.

19 · PAGE PATTERNS

PROVEN ON A LIVE PAGE.

Patterns built and reviewed on the Champions share page, October 2026. Use them before inventing new ones.

theme by product

Dark or light is decided per product, not per page. Recommended: Founders Event and Champion pages dark (black and gold), the book light, BMC|COLLECTIVE dark. A light/dark toggle is a review tool for deciding, not a feature to ship.

resource banner

A solid gold band at the very top naming the program ("Champion Resources") with the event line on the right. Above the nav, not inside it.

card rail

Overlapping cards in a row, one per offer, led by a card with a red-to-gold gradient border. Hover pulls one card up and pushes the rest aside. Swipe with snap on touch.

gift row

One full-bleed section per offer: a giant ghosted number behind, headline, one bold line, a "why give it" plate, one solid CTA, a 3D object on the other side, and a testimonial with a real photo at the foot.

send modal

Info on one side, form on the other. Native dialog, closes on Esc, the X or the backdrop, keeps focus inside, opens as a bottom sheet on a phone. Pre-writes the message and lets the person edit it before anything is sent.

mobile action bar

On phones the offers become a sticky bar in the thumb zone. Hidden over the hero, slides in on scroll, hides at the footer. Targets at least 56px tall.

No **Rounded corners on full-width sections.** A big radius on a band reads as a glitch unless something visibly moves or stacks to explain it. Bands stay square; depth comes from shadow and light.

No Line-and-label eyebrows above headlines (section 09).

Yes Several dynamic things per page. Flat is the failure, not too much motion.

20 · REFERENCES

WHAT THE BAR LOOKS LIKE.

The references the team has pointed to. Study them before a new page, not after.

hardybmc.com

Heavy uppercase, key words in the accent, a dark hero with the real Darren, a stats band, short hard lines.

superhuman.com

The person surrounded by floating panels of their world (section 12).

css-tricks.com

The overlapping card rail (section 19).

Apple, Stripe, Linear, Vercel, Framer

Depth from layers, light and slow motion rather than more colour.

DesignRush luxury roundup

Type carries the brand; copy names concrete things; one saturated accent saved for action; always a route to a person.

saasfactor.co: buttons, modals, mobile, UX optimisation

Tactile buttons; info and form modals; mobile as its own experience (thumb zone, bottom sheets, snap rails); every page treated as a test with tracked actions.

taskade.com hero

Saved for a future page. An icon menu right in the hero: a row of small icon-over-label tabs under the headline, the active one on a soft plate, each switching the product preview that rises beneath it. Pairs with a second headline line set ghosted in a lower tier, perspective grid lines framing the hero, and a preview panel with a lit gradient rim.

To study

DesignRush best tech sites. A specific Behance project (only the home page was shared).

21 · OPEN ITEMS

WHAT IS NOT SETTLED YET.

OPEN

The jacket's title face. Licences are bought and wired in, but the measurements say the jacket was not set in Bebas. Identifying it is the last open question on type.

NEEDS DH

A drawn wordmark. The lockup is set type. For four sites and any merchandise, a drawn mark is worth commissioning.

NEEDS A CALL

Dark or light for the Champions page. Recommended dark. Once chosen, the review toggle comes off.

FIX

The Champions page drifts from this guide. It was built on the older stylesheet values: the warm paper #FBFAF8 instead of pure white, red #E02826 instead of #E1132E, coloured button glows, pill-shaped

toggle and chips, rounded cards, and one italic serif sample. Bring it into line, or rule that any of these should change here instead.

FIX

tceb.css still sets .btn and .eyebrow in Bebas. The stylesheet should follow sections 07 and 09 so every page inherits the fix.

UNCONFIRMED

The TCE palette is measured from the 10th Anniversary cover artwork in the repo, not supplied by DH. The colours are sound; the file's proportions may be an ebook mock rather than the real trim.

UNCONFIRMED

The body face. Not yet checked against the jacket. If it is Franklin, this becomes a two-face system.
